JalRakshak: agentic flood early warning and response for India

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Event: Clash of Commits · **Track:** AI & Machine Learning
Code: https://github.com/madhavzanwar/Jal-rakshak · **Live demo:** https://madhavzanwar.github.io/Jal-rakshak/

PROBLEM

About 40 million hectares, roughly 12% of India, is flood-prone, and floods and heavy rain killed 1,09,374 people between 1953 and 2018 [1, 2]. Good rainfall and river forecasts exist, but they rarely become ward-level, local-language instructions that a district officer can approve and a citizen can act on in time.

SOLUTION

JalRakshak is an agentic early-warning and response platform that runs on a laptop with zero paid services or API keys. It pulls free Open-Meteo rainfall forecasts and GloFAS river-discharge forecasts for 12 flood-prone cities (Mumbai, Chennai, Guwahati, Patna, Kochi, Srinagar, Kolkata, Bhubaneswar, Surat, Hyderabad, Pune, Dibrugarh) and computes a transparent 0–100 ward-level flood-risk score for the next 72 hours from IMD rainfall categories, GloFAS percentile thresholds, antecedent rain and ward vulnerability, shown as Green, Yellow, Orange or Red with every factor visible. An optional LightGBM model adds a flood-day probability, reported with an honest time-split backtest.

AGENTIC LAYER

Four agents run on a local open LLM (Ollama, Qwen2.5 3B) through our own ReAct tool-calling loop, with a deterministic rules fallback. The **Monitor** decides when to alert; the **Alert drafter** writes SMS (≤160 characters) and WhatsApp alerts in English, हिन्दी, मराठी, தமிழ் and বাংলা; the **Evacuation planner** finds the nearest safe shelters and hospitals with OSRM routing; the **SitRep** agent writes a district-officer situation report (PDF). Guardrails reject invented numbers, wrong scripts and over-length messages and require the 112 helpline. Every step is logged with its reasoning and inputs, and nothing is sent without human approval (dispatch is simulated in the prototype).

USERS AND IMPACT

Officers get a map dashboard, ward drill-down, agent timeline and one-click approval. Citizens get a light, offline-capable page for low-end phones with their risk, what to do now, the nearest shelter and emergency numbers. Just 24 hours' warning can cut damage by about 30% [3].

BUILT WITH

FastAPI, React PWA (Leaflet, Recharts), Ollama + Qwen2.5, LightGBM, OpenStreetMap, OSRM, Open-Meteo, GloFAS; `docker compose up`; demo replay of a synthetic Assam-monsoon-inspired flood. Open source (MIT).

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[1] Rashtriya Barh Ayog (1980) via PIB, 2022. [2] Standing Committee on Water Resources, 17th Lok Sabha (via Down To Earth, 2021). [3] Global Commission on Adaptation, via UN Early Warnings for All. Full URLs in submission/SOURCES.md.